

IN TEST: 9 SOUND EDITING SOFTWARE



Imaging: Solomon Lewis

For the love of Mike

Changing the gravel and leather voice of a rock icon to sound like the dulcet tones of an opera singer is as easy as pie with the right sound editing software

YATISH SUVARNA

Audio-editing software have moved on from being plain Jane editing tools to programs that give you acoustic realism. With these powerful tools you can make Limp Bizkit sound like Puff Daddy or even record your own voice and make it sound like that of Plácido Domingo. The better ones among the lot currently available not only provide you with the basic tools, but also give you some great plugins, which can be downloaded from the Internet along with tutorials and sound files.

Professionals now have a set of tools, which grant them unparalleled versatility in audio authoring. And looking at the versatility of the products, novices too can edit their music to make it sound close enough to that of the pros. This test examines three important aspects—features, ease of use, performance and price. So

check out this review, mix your own song and let your audio system rip!

This test is targeted at the home user who expects reasonably good features, which would be useful for editing audio at that level and still respecting ease of use and the price. The prime focus of these software is therefore going to be the feature set supported and also the ease with which these features can be learnt and implemented.

Wave Editing software

The applications tested here are primarily used while working with and editing Wave files, as opposed to MIDI audio. In the world of digital audio, Wave files are one of the most commonly used audio formats and form the basis of audio media such as audio CD. This format is used to store digital audio data using a method called PCM (Pulse Code Modulation). When a